A Controversial Journey in Indian Politics

"From the Grassroots to the Globe - BJP, India's Political Powerhouse."

The Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) is a well-known and powerful political organisation in India that is well-known for its Hindu nationalist and cultural nationalism ideologies. It was founded in 1980 and has connections to the RSS. The BJP has earned support for its goal of building a strong India under the leadership of figures like Narendra Modi. With a focus on economic reforms, infrastructural development, and good governance, it has been electorally successful. However, its links to Hindu nationalism and the RSS have raised discussions over secularism and minority rights.

History

The Bharatiya Jana Sangh (BJS), the Janata Party, and the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS) were among the political groups and factions that came together to form the BJP on April 6, 1980. Right-wing Hindu nationalist group the RSS's political branch, the BJS, was established in 1951.The BJP concentrated on developing a distinctive nationalist and Hindutva philosophy in its early years. It fought for economic reforms and national unity while also promoting cultural nationalism on behalf of the Hindu community, who made up the majority of the population.

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Bharatiya Janata Party launched

Vajpayee elected president

Members 'free' to attend shakhas

Zail Singh asked to resign

Assam stir intensified

Ordinance bans strikes in Assam

Shah panel SSP superseded

In the 1980s and early 1990s, the BJP saw electoral triumph, particularly in northern and western states like Gujarat, Madhya Pradesh, and Rajasthan. It became a well-known opposition party in the Indian Parliament, challenging the Indian National Congress's hegemony. Ram Janmabhoomi Movement: The BJP attracted a lot of attention in the late 1980s and early 1990s as a result of its engagement in the Ram Janmabhoomi movement. The party, along with a number of right-wing organisations, advocated for the building of a Ram temple at Ayodhya, which is said to be the location of Lord Ram's birth. The movement broadened the BJP's support base and thrust it into the national forefront.

The BJP became the single-largest party in the Lok Sabha (lower house of Parliament) after the 1996 national elections. With the assistance of other political parties, it established a coalition government, and Atal Bihari Vajpayee was appointed as prime minister for the first time. In the elections of 1998 and 1999, the BJP-led coalition known as the National Democratic Alliance (NDA) took back control. Throughout these decades, Atal Bihari Vajpayee served as prime minister and oversaw a broad and stable coalition.

Rise

The BJP became a powerful national political force in the 1980s and 1990s, pushing away from its regional strongholds in northern and western India. A sizable portion of the Indian public identified with the party's emphasis on Hindutva, cultural nationalism, and economic reforms. A turning point for the BJP was the Ram Janmabhoomi agitation in the late 1980s and early 1990s. The party aggressively supported the movement to have a Ram temple built at the contentious location in Ayodhya, Uttar Pradesh. The movement stoked Hindu pride and broadened the BJP's base of support.

The leadership of the BJP, especially under figures like Atal Bihari Vajpayee and L.K. Advani was essential in forming the party's identity and communication plan. The popularity of the party was boosted by their oratory prowess, political knowledge, and capacity for relating to the general public. The BJP was able to broaden its influence and win the support of several regional actors because of its readiness to establish coalitions with other political parties, such as the National Democratic Alliance (NDA). The BJP was able to increase its support and solidify its position of power in a number of states through using coalition politics.

A segment of the population desiring a change in the status quo connected with the BJP's emphasis on development and economic changes, as evidenced in the "India Shining" campaign in the early 2000s and subsequently in the "Gujarat Model" under Narendra Modi's leadership. The BJP used social media and technology to connect with a younger, tech-savvy population. The party's election triumph was aided by its use of social media platforms and digital campaign techniques.

The Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS), a powerful and well-organized right-wing Hindu nationalist organisation, was affiliated with the BJP, giving the party a strong organisational

foundation and broad base of support. The growth of Narendra Modi as a charismatic leader and his position as Gujarat's Chief Minister contributed to the BJP's support and a resounding victory in the national elections of 2014 and 2019. A wide range of people were drawn to his charismatic leadership, emphasis on good government, and promises of economic prosperity.

Ideology

The BJP's primary philosophy, known as Hindutva, acts as a foundational element for all of the party's programmes and initiatives. It places a strong emphasis on promoting Hindu ancestry, culture, and values as the cornerstone of Indian identity. Hindutva attempts to instill a sense of national pride among Hindus and promotes the conservation and preservation of Hindu traditions.The philosophy of the BJP places a strong emphasis on preserving and advancing India's rich cultural legacy. The party upholds the notion that India is a country with a distinctive and rich cultural fabric that includes many different traditions, languages, and customs.

The BJP prioritises the interests of the country above everything else and fights for a strong and unified India. The party's vision of India as a strong and independent nation on the international stage is centred on nationalism. The BJP is renowned for taking a socially conservative position on topics including cultural norms, gender roles, and family values. The party frequently backs measures that adhere to conventional beliefs and customs.

The BJP has adopted economic liberalism even if its philosophy is based in cultural and social conservatism. To promote economic growth and development, it backs privatisation, market-based economic policies, and foreign investment. The BJP was founded on the concept of Pandit Deendayal Upadhyaya, a proponent of "Integral Humanism." This philosophy places a strong emphasis on the integration of a person's personal, social, and spiritual spheres of existence, with a particular attention to the wellbeing of all socioeconomic classes.
Connection with RSS

The Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS) and the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) have a long-standing relationship. The BJP was established as the political branch of the RSS, a right-wing Hindu nationalist group that advocates Hindutva, in 1980. The BJP's ideas and tactics have been significantly inspired by the philosophy of the RSS. The RSS offers the BJP considerable organisational assistance as well as grassroots mobilisation, and many BJP officials have ties to the organisation. They have similar objectives, and the RSS helps the BJP make policy choices. The BJP is a political party, but the RSS is a cultural organisation, hence they are distinct from one another. Depending on their perspectives on Hindutva and cultural nationalism, the relationship between the two has both proponents and opponents.

Policies made by them

The Goods and Services Tax (GST) is a comprehensive indirect tax reform that promoted a national common market by replacing several levies with a single, unified tax structure. A financial inclusion programme called Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana (PMJDY) aims to give banking services to all families, particularly the unbanked and poor groups. PMJAY: Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana It offers health insurance coverage to disadvantaged people so they may access secondary and tertiary treatment. It is also known as Ayushman Bharat. Make in India: An initiative to support indigenous manufacturing and draw in international capital to spur economic expansion and add employment.

Swachh Bharat Abhiyan: An initiative to enhance sanitation in rural and urban regions and promote national cleanliness. Digital India is a programme that aims to make India into a society where everyone has access to the internet by establishing digital infrastructure and fostering digital literacy. Ujjwala Yojana: Reduces indoor air pollution and encourages clean cooking by giving women from families below the poverty line free LPG connections. In order to combat

unemployment, Skill India focuses on improving the skills and employability of young people by offering training in a variety of areas. A programme called Beti Bachao, Beti Padhao seeks to increase females' access to school and to power. It also addresses the issue of the dropping child sex ratio.

Controversies

While in power in India, the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) has encountered several scandals. The Ayodhya Ram Temple and Babri Masjid controversy, the Gujarat riots in 2002, and charges of racial polarisation to increase the number of Hindu votes are only a few of these issues. Concerns concerning secularism and minority rights have been raised as a result of the party's affiliation with the RSS and the Hindutva movement. Freedom of speech concerns, cow vigilantism events, and criticism of the Electoral Bond Scheme's lack of transparency have all been contentious issues. In addition, several detractors have voiced their disagreement with the party's stance on caste-based prejudice and social justice. These incidents have spurred continuing political discussions and debates in India, bringing to light the difficulties of administering a varied country while juggling ideological and social interests. The BJP's electoral trajectory and the political environment in India will continue to be shaped by its capacity to solve these concerns.

Conclusion

With origins in the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS) and an emphasis on cultural nationalism and Hindutva philosophy, the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) is a well-known political party in India. It has had electoral success since its founding in 1980 and has become a powerful force in Indian politics. The party, led by figures like Atal Bihari Vajpayee and Narendra Modi, has gained supporters by placing a strong focus on governmental changes, infrastructural growth, and economic reforms. Discussions concerning secularism and minority rights have been generated by the BJP's affiliation with the RSS and Hindutva. Despite controversy, the BJP's history has had a significant influence on Indian politics, and its programmes continue to have an impact on the country's future.